



American Board
of Internal Medicine®

Building an AI Powered Innovation Team

with Persistent Organizational Intelligence

David Solot and Zak Barbezat

Disclosures



Zak Barbezat

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American Board of Internal Medicine



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American Board of Internal Medicine

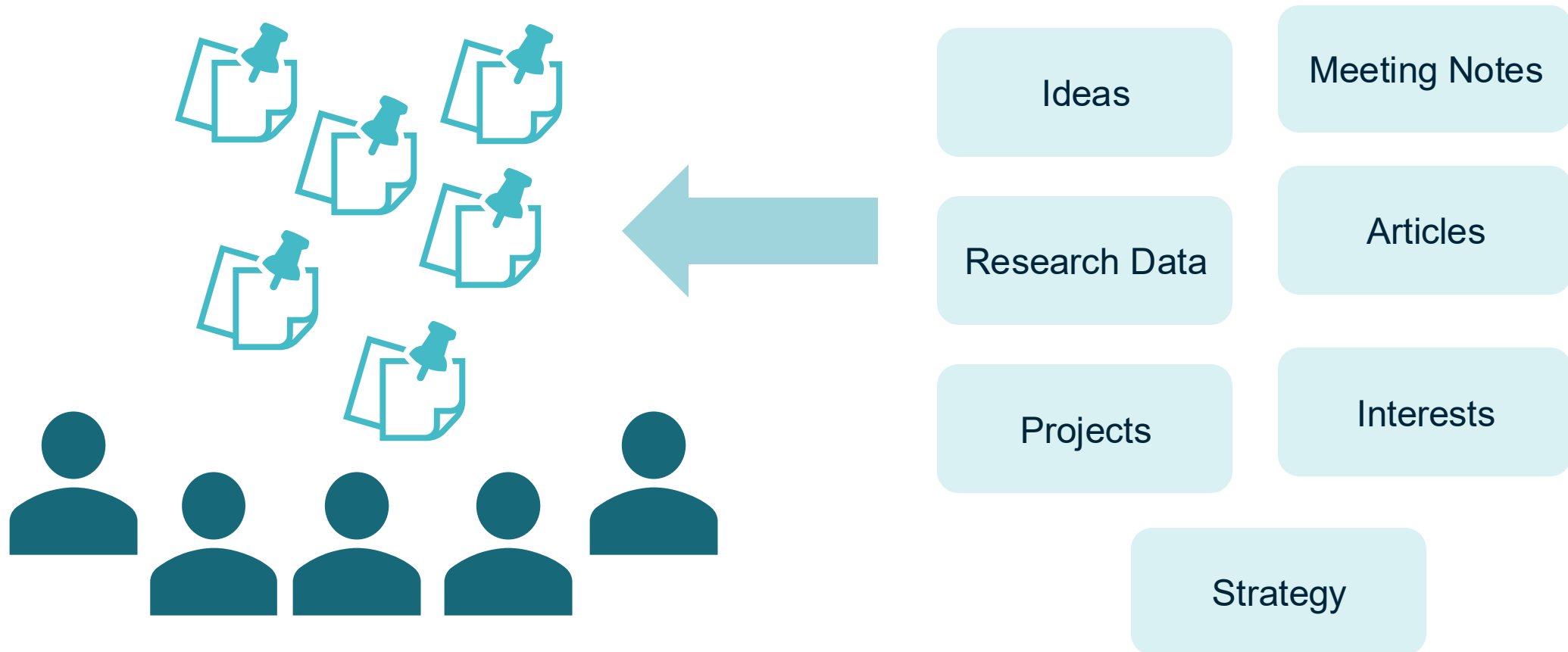
Nothing presented today will appear on any exam question you take from ABIM.

A practical build story

- Information and innovation
- Contribution of LLMs and Knowledge Bases
- How a connected workflow works
- What changed for our team
- Live demo with conference data

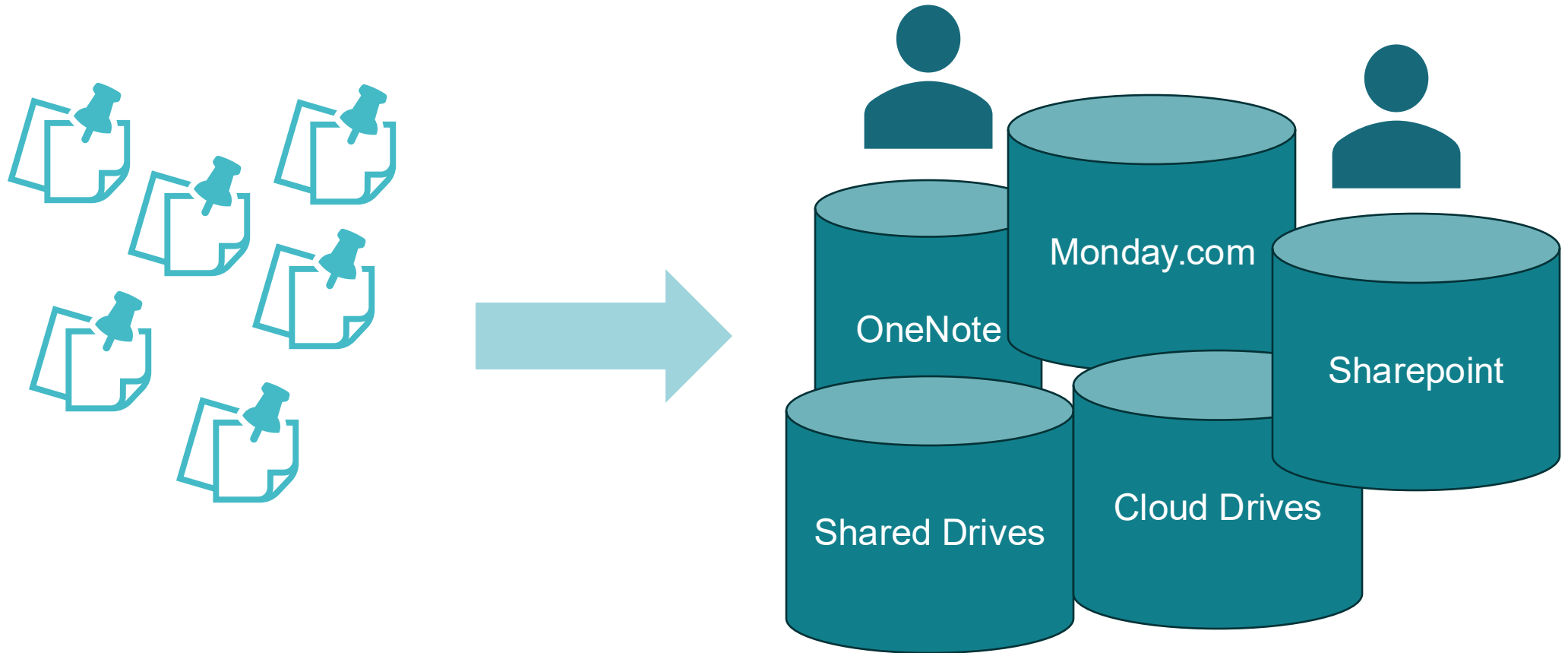
Problem

Innovative work generates a lot of information.



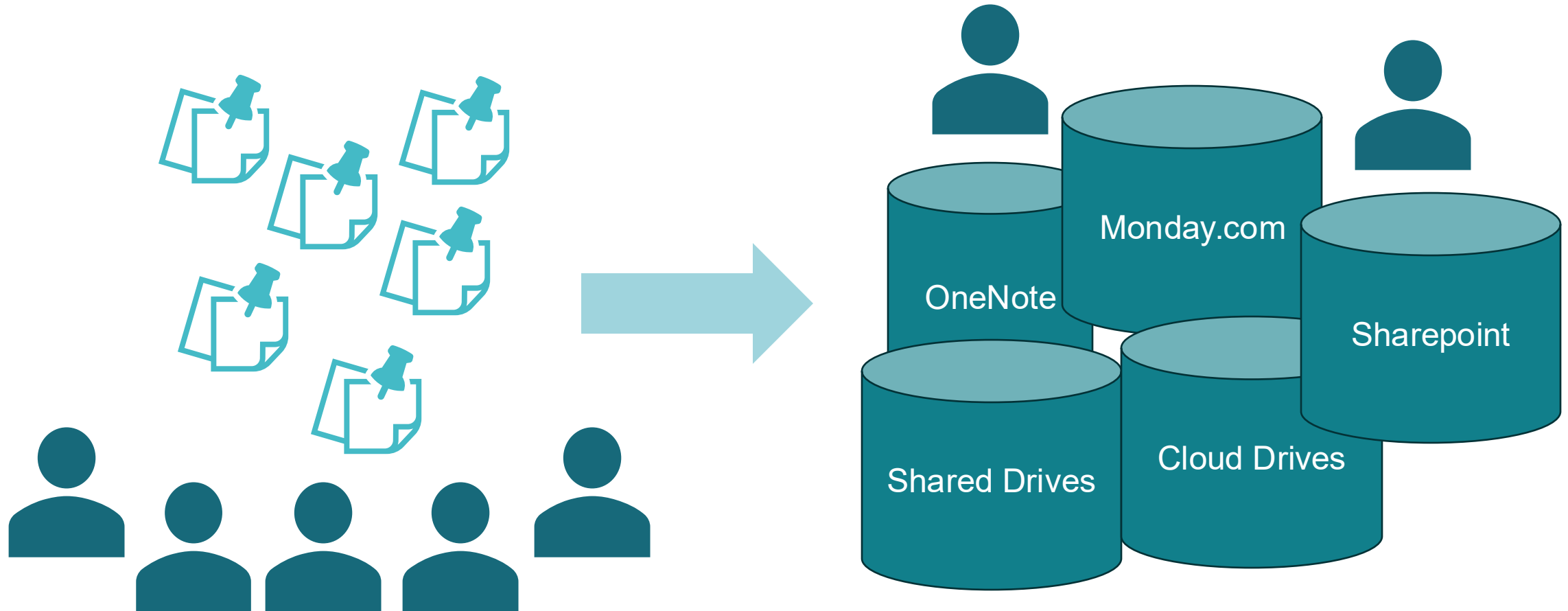
Problem

We keep it in a variety of places.



Problem

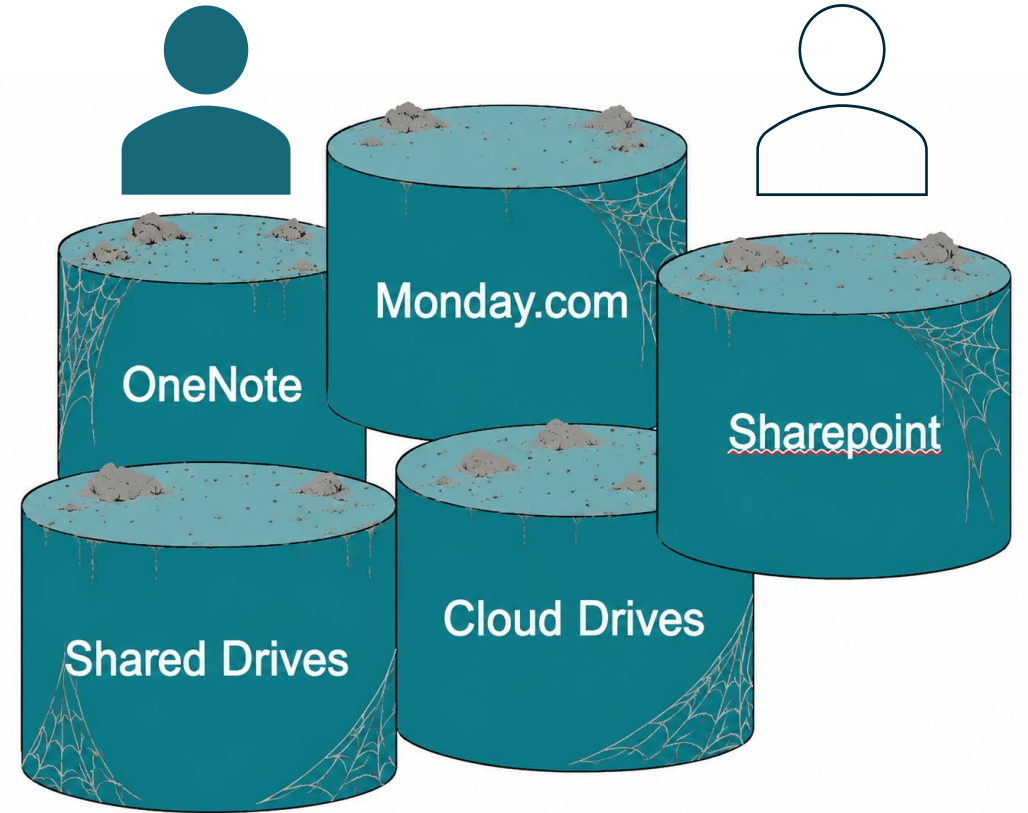
While we do more work and generate more information.



Problem

But we don't fully leverage it to inform our work.

- People leave
- Data structures are dense
- Too much information
- Irrelevant information



Having the data doesn't mean we're using the data

How can we make that data easier to use?

Text was always machine-readable

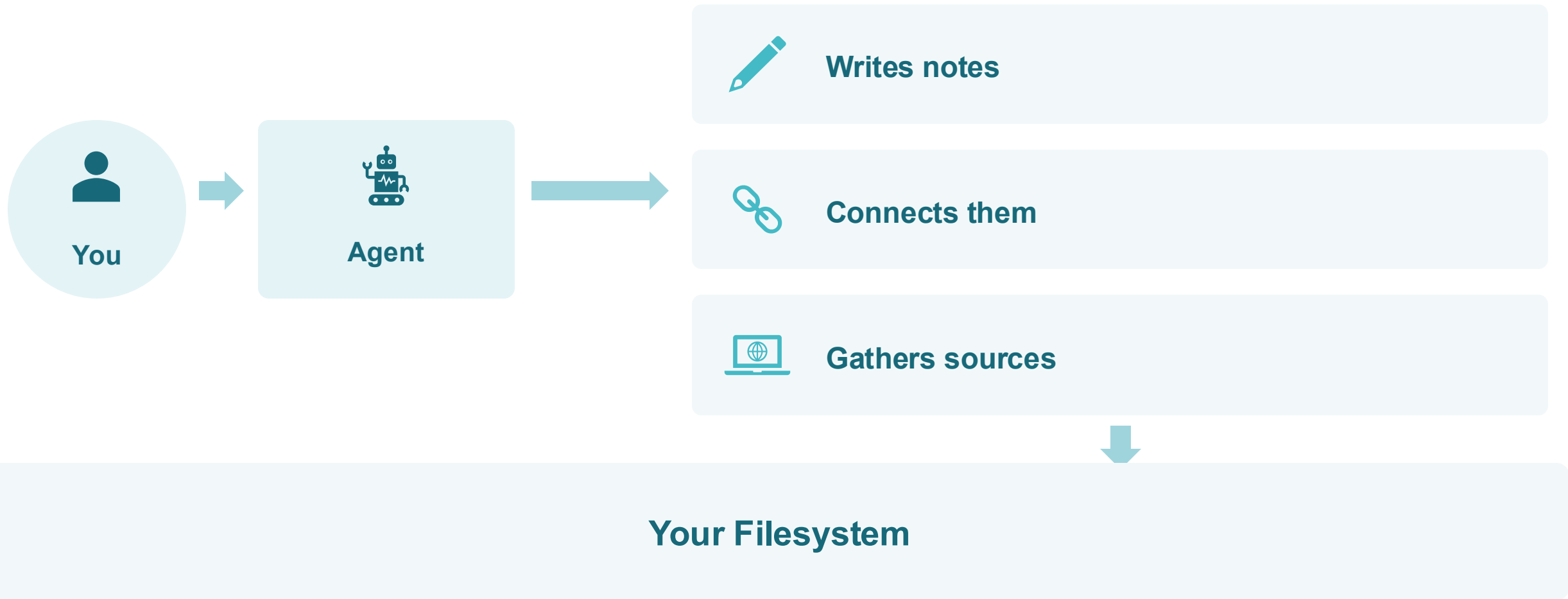
- Decks, packets, emails
- But software could not extract meaning from it

Large language models changed that

- They respond to what words mean
- Any text you already have becomes usable



Agentic Workflows



Obsidian

A free app that opens **a folder of markdown files on your machine**. No account, no cloud.
It adds links, tags, and search on top.



Search and backlinks



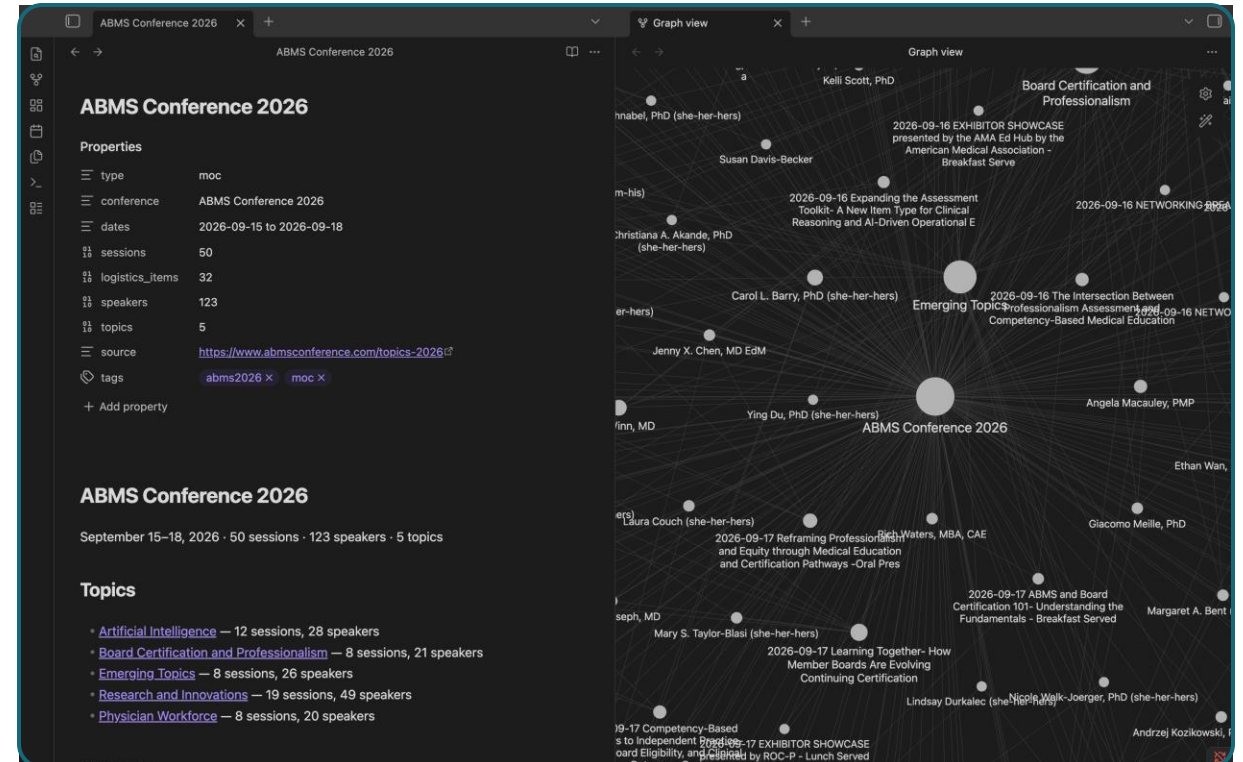
Frontmatter



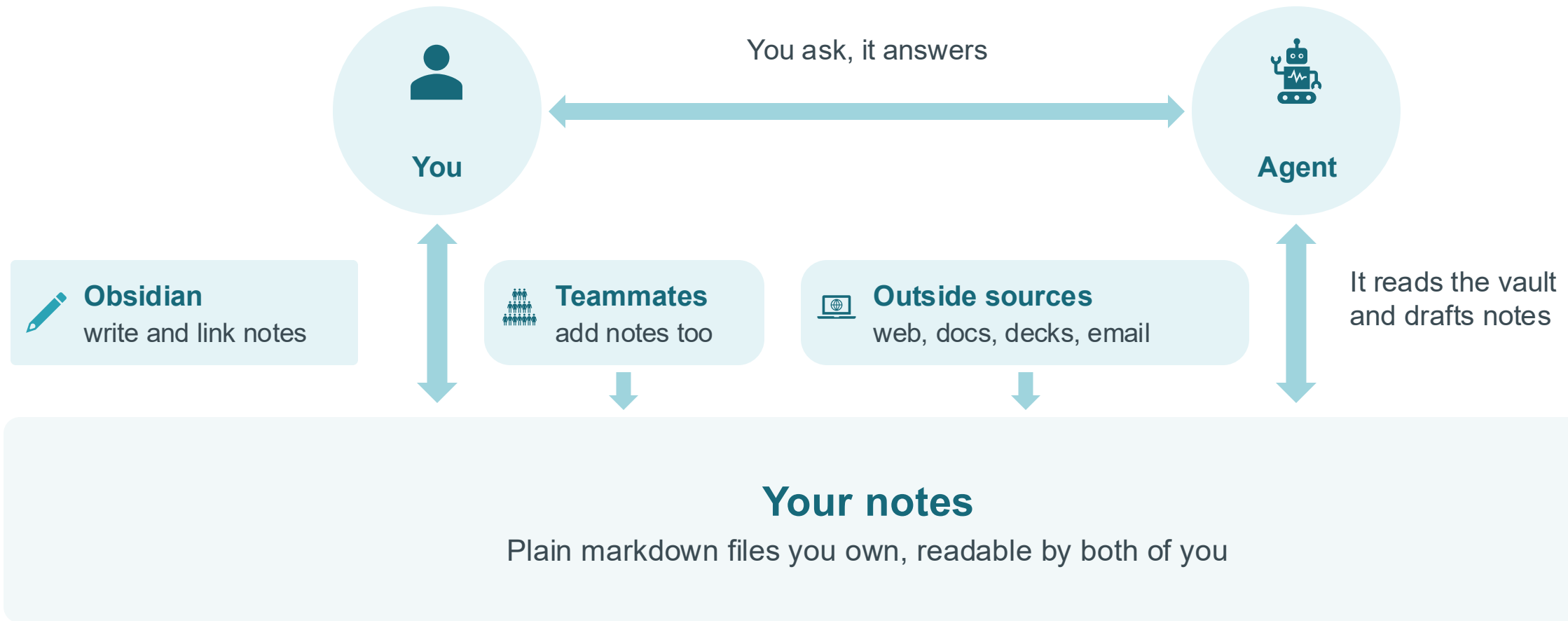
Local files



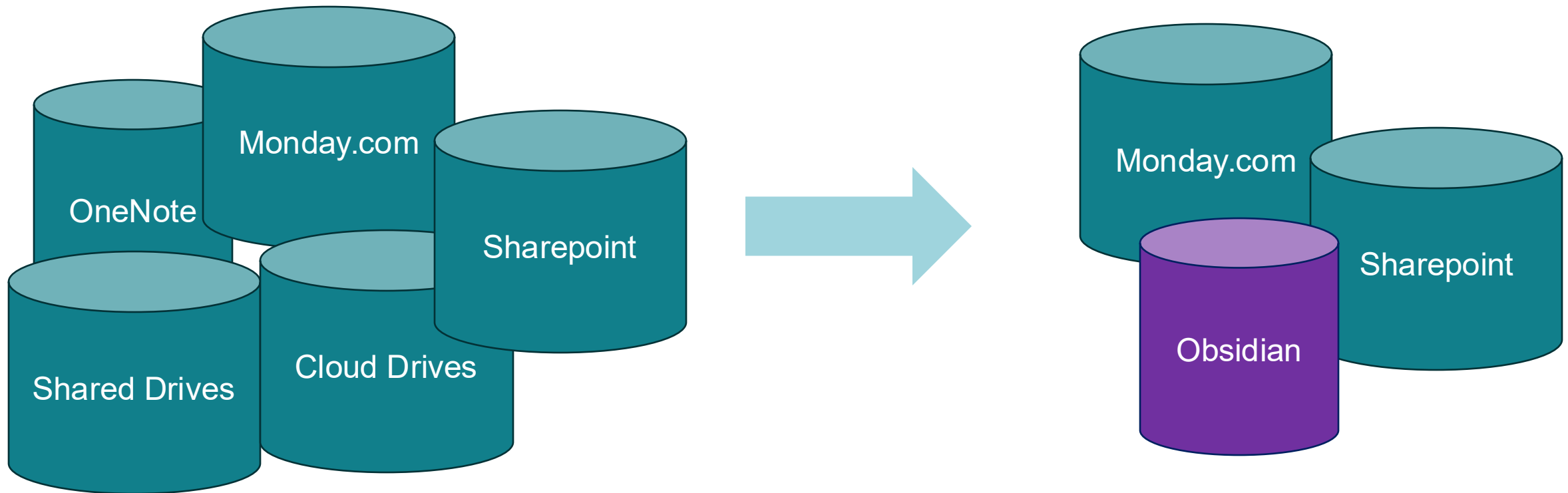
Graph view



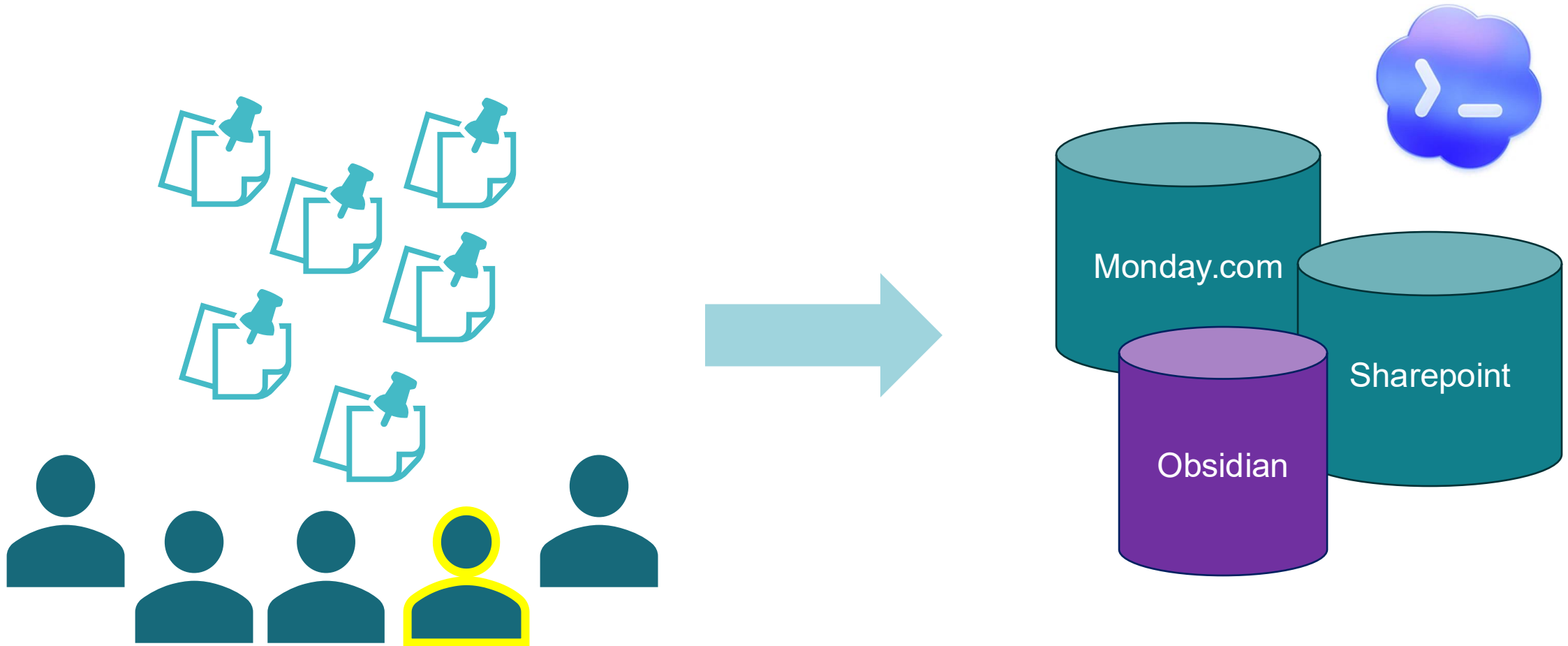
The Result



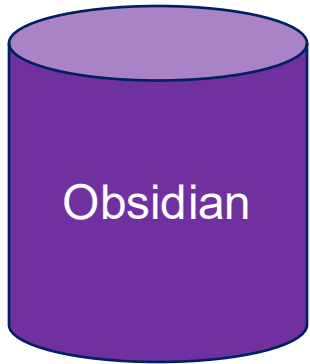
How we use both at ABIM



How we use both at ABIM



How we use both at ABIM



- > ABIM-David
- > Confidential
- > Meetings
- > People
- > Projects
- > Reference

Today
Waiting

We're going to use my Obsidian Vault for the work we do together. It's on my hard drive, in Documents/ABIM-David. First make sure you can access it. Then, I want you to learn about me, my role, the people I work with, and the projects I'm working on. I want you to act as my chief of staff - I need you to help me with project management, administrative tasks, and brainstorming. Create a folder for yourself where you can keep information about how I want to work with you.

How we use both at ABIM

- > ABIM-David
 - > Codex Assistant
 - | Collaboration Log
 - | Open Questions
 - | README
 - | Preferences
 - > Confidential
 - > Meetings
 - > People
 - > Projects
 - > Reference

Today
Waiting

I want to start working with you on project management for the Lab. We currently have several projects in the area of Transformative Testing that I'm responsible for running (and participating in). I want to ensure that we're making consistent progress and have a plan.

I started by putting us on a soft Agile type workflow, with 2 week sprints. However, I haven't been disciplined in keeping up with that. I want to make a fresh start and get organized.

We have Monday.com which I want to use for project tracking, and my Obsidian Vault (ABIM-Solot) that you have access to.

I'd like you to work with me on getting these projects organized. I'm going to stop there, and let you ask questions, rather than dictate how we should work.

How we use both at ABIM

- > ETD-Zak
 - > Articles
 - > People
 - > Projects
 - > Reference

Today

Waiting

I read a lot of newsletters, blogs, research previews, and papers about new technologies. There are several files already here containing details about these articles and stuff I jotted down while reading the article.

I want you to help me by finding connections between some of my recent readings and the projects and people who are also working on my team. Please provide me with one or two connections per article I have read within the last week.

If the link is thin, say so and ask me for context instead of guessing.

How we use both at ABIM

ARTICLE I SAVED LAST WEEK

"LLMs reward expertise"

Sean Goedecke, Aug 3. Models amplify what you already know, so the gap between experts and novices widens rather than closes.

CONNECTION

David Solot: this is the counterpoint to "Domain Experts Have Always Been the Real Moat," already in your Clippings from May. Your annotation there argued that verifying output and specifying rules are different skills. Goedecke pushes the other way.

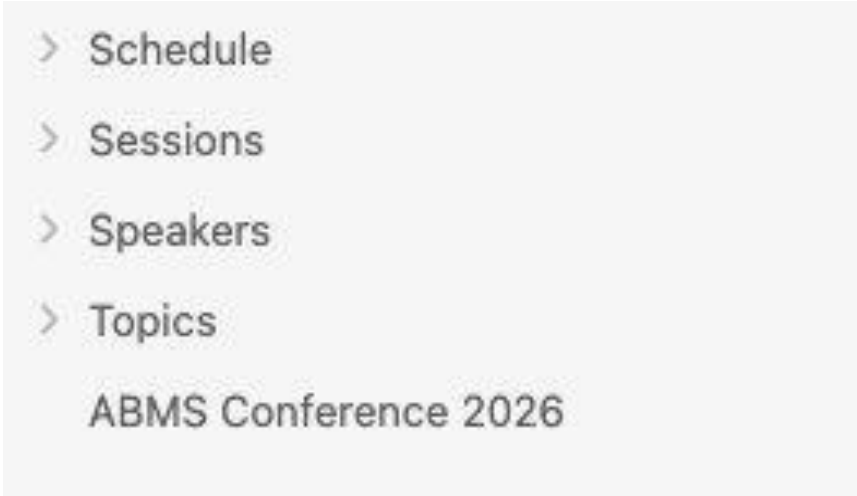
WHY IT MATTERS FOR OUR WORK

If models amplify the expertise someone already has, then measuring competency could include cover judging and verifying AI output, not just recall. Worth putting both articles in front of David as we shape that work.

Demo – ABMS Conference

What we did

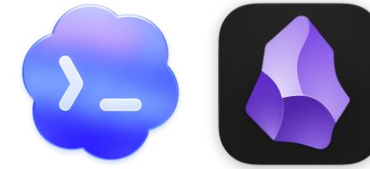
- Gathered all available conference info
- Created an Obsidian Vault
- Gave access to Claude Code (Zak) and Codex (David)



A screenshot of an Obsidian vault interface. It shows a sidebar with four expandable sections: 'Schedule', 'Sessions', 'Speakers', and 'Topics'. Below these sections, the text 'ABMS Conference 2026' is displayed.

```
> Schedule
> Sessions
> Speakers
> Topics
ABMS Conference 2026
```

Demo – David's Version



📁 ABMS Conference Expert

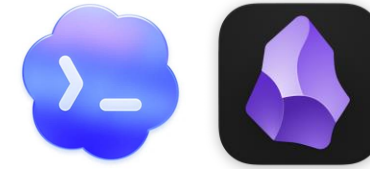
You have access to an Obsidian Vault that contains information about the ABMS Conference 2026. Look through the vault and familiarize yourself with the information. Then make a folder for yourself where you can store information related to my queries and how I want you to work with me. When I ask you questions about the conference, use this vault as your primary reference. Give me concise answers, with bullet points when appropriate. |

+ 🖐️ Ask for approval

⚡ 5.5 Medium ▾



Demo – David's Version



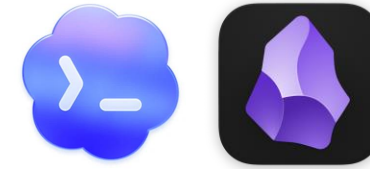
Worked for 42s >

Done. I reviewed the ABMS 2026 vault structure and created:

- [📄 README.md](#)
- [📄 Working Preferences.md](#)
- [📄 Query Notes.md](#)

I'll use this vault as the primary reference for conference questions, keep answers concise, use bullets when helpful, and check schedule/session/speaker notes directly before making recommendations or inferences.

Demo – David's Version



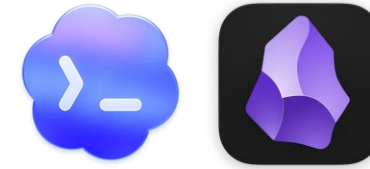
I want to attend sessions that demonstrate how other boards are currently leveraging AI for certification. Which sessions should I attend?

+  Ask for approval

⚡ 5.5 Medium ▾



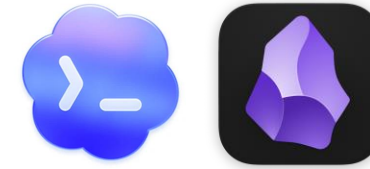
Demo – David's Version



Best fits from the vault:

- **Wed 9/16, 1:30-2:30 PM CST — [Innovations in Certification and Accreditation Assessments: AI-Enabled Scoring, Feedback Analysis, and Longitudinal Assessment Item Calibration](#)**
Strong match. Includes **American Board of Anesthesiology** using AI to analyze diplomate feedback on MOCA Minute items, plus longitudinal assessment calibration work.
- **Wed 9/16, 3:00-4:00 PM CST — [Expanding the Assessment Toolkit: A New Item Type for Clinical Reasoning and AI-Driven Operational Efficiency](#)**
Very strong match. **American Board of Pediatrics** presenters describe LLM-personalized feedback and a multi-agent AI framework for high-stakes exam production.
- **Thu 9/17, 10:45-11:45 AM CST — [Using Large Language Models to Reduce the Workload for](#)**

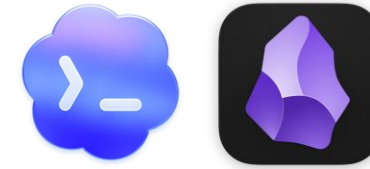
Demo – David's Version



Examine all the sessions related to AI use in certification. What are the big picture themes across sessions, and why do they matter?

- AI is forcing boards to rethink what “competence” means.
- Assessment is moving beyond right/wrong scoring.
- AI is becoming part of certification operations, not just research.
- Human-in-the-loop models are the dominant safety posture.
- Feedback is becoming more personalized and actionable.
- AI governance is becoming a certification issue in its own right.
- Infrastructure and knowledge management are emerging as hidden prerequisites.

Demo – David's Version



On Friday, Zak Barbezat and I are presenting about using AI to build a more effective innovation team. Look in the vault and learn about my presentation topic, and about all the people registered to attend the conference. Then try to predict the five attendees who are most likely to be interested in this session. Tell me who they are, and what I can do to tailor our presentation to their interests. Do not include ABIM employees in the top five. You can use information outside of the vault to help you decide (such as my emails).

Ting Wang, PhD, American Board of Pediatrics

David A. Turner, MD, American Board of Pediatrics

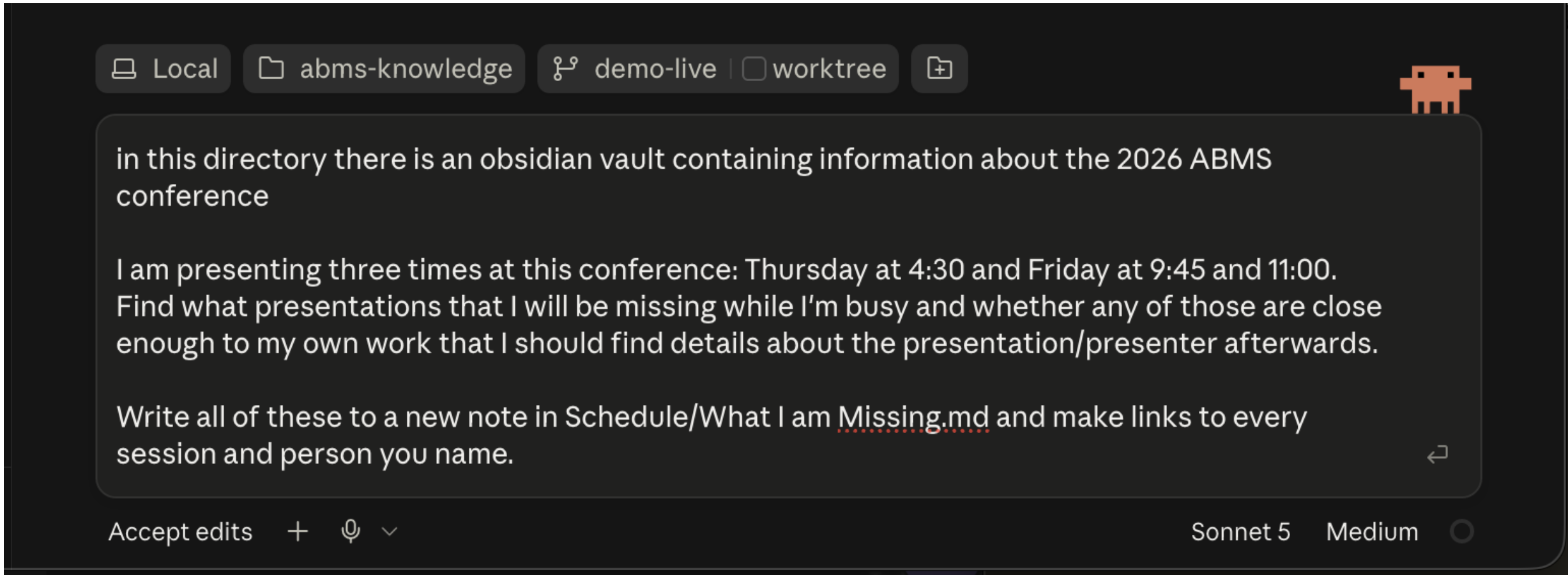
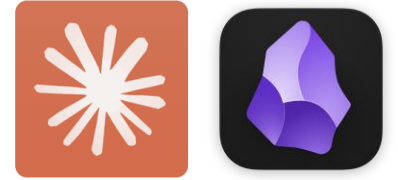
Nathan W. Sanders, American Board of Physical Medicine and Rehabilitation

Anna Menzies, The American Board of Anesthesiology

David D. Shin, PhD, American Board of Psychiatry & Neurology

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Demo – Zak's Version



Demo – Zak's Version



Ran 2 commands, read 2026-09-17 Schedule.md >

Confirmed: Zak Barbezat is presenting Thursday 16:30 slot ("Building an AI-Powered Innovation Team"). Now let me check Friday's schedule for the other two talks.

Read a file, ran 5 commands, created a file +16 -55 >

I've created [What I Am Missing.md](#) covering all three of your presentation slots (Thu 4:30, Fri 9:45, Fri 11:00).

Key takeaways:

- **Thursday 4:30 slot:** [Using LLMs to Score ABS Oral Certifying Exams](#) is the standout — ABS's own AI-scoring pilot, very close to your work.
- **Friday 9:45 slot:** [Strengthening Professionalism, Equity, and Targeted Learning Pathways](#) includes Jeffrey Miller's ABIM talk on individualized learning paths — nearly the same subject as your own "Beyond the Score," worth comparing notes with him directly. [Advancing Continuing Certification through Article-Based Assessment](#) also has direct AI/certification overlap (ABOG's LLM-accuracy study).
- **Friday 11:00 slot:** both alternatives are only loosely related (AI in podcasting; AI pitfalls in literature reviews) — lower priority to chase down.

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What we covered

- Most of what the team knows sits in inboxes, decks and people's heads.
- So we put it in an Obsidian vault and gave the agents access to it.
- Now the agents answer from the team's own notes, not just what they picked up in training.
- One demo found the ABMS sessions worth attending. The other linked a new article to a colleague's work.

Thank You

Questions?



510 Walnut Street, Suite 1700, Philadelphia, PA 19106 | abim.org